One peculiarity of the Indian adaptation of the food pyramid is the recommendation to do regular physical activity. The pyramid provides information on the food types and amount necessary to meet daily dietary requirements. Each food group is represented by a band or level. Narrow bands at the apex indicate lower quantities, while wider bands at the base means that more from that food group needs to be consumed.

Most important is to include 2 to 3 litre of water each day as it's the most important nutrient constituting 70% of our body weight and helps to maintain our health.

It is very important that an individual incorporates the principles of good nutrition such as variety, a balanced intake of nutrients and moderation. The best way to meet the daily requirements is to eat a diet that combines cereals, fruits, vegetables, meat, fish, poultry legumes and dairy products. Eating a variety of foods daily as guided by the "Food Pyramid" will help to provide all the nutrients needed by the body.

3.5 METHODS OF COOKING

Cooking has been practiced since times immemorial. The ancient man ate only raw food.Once a piece of meat fell into the fire accidentally and got roasted. The ancient man ate this piece of roasted meat and liked it. Thus began the process of cooking. It has evolved a lot since then.

Cooking offers a wide variety of foods. For example food items like roti, puri, paratha, rice, pulao, pulses, vegetable, salad, chutney, pickle, curd, butter milk, fruits, etc.are prepared from different food.

Boiled rice tastes different from jeera rice or pea pulao because these are cooked differently. Similarly, a chapatti tastes different from a puree or paratha, again because all these are cooked differently. Generally, vegetables like tomatoes, cucumber and fruits are best eaten raw while wheat, rice, pulses, potatoes and other vegetables must be cooked. Main objectives of cooking:

- Improves the taste and food quality.
- Cooking food to the required temperature for a required length of time can destroy all harmful microorganisms in food.
- Cooking improves digestibility.
- Cooking increases variety.

3.5.1 Moist Heat Methods

i) Boiling: Boiling is cooking foods by just immersing them in water at 100°C and maintaining the water at that temperature till the food is tender. It does not require special skill and equipment. It is time consuming.

Merits:

1. Simple method, does not require skill or any particular equipment.
2. Uniform cooking can be achieved.

Demerits:

1. Continuous boiling damages the structure and texture of food.
2. Vitamins B and C is lost if the cooking water is discarded.
3. It is time consuming and may lead to increased use of fuel.
4. Loss of colour —Water soluble pigments may be lost during cooking.

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